ABCC Judging Scoresheet — Official Rubric Replica

ABCC 2027 preparation · 01 · Competition

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Printable scoresheet for every HSBI simulation. It replicates the **official ABCC judging rubric** (2025 Event Guide baseline, applied to **all rounds**): seven categories, each scored **1–10 in whole numbers**, multiplied by its weight and summed to a **weighted total out of 105** (weights sum to 10.5). Use it exactly as written in every mock — the same seven questions decide the real competition, and after the traditional-case tie-breaker, further ties are resolved by **rubric-category performance in weight order**, so the heavy categories matter twice.

The criterion questions in the table are the official wording; the 3/7/10 behavioural anchors are our coaching interpretation of that wording, added so scores stay comparable across judges and months.

Print one sheet per judge per team. If the judge is **external** — the calendar asks for one at W17, W23–24 and both W25 rounds, and W19 is graded too if you can get one — brief them from the last section of this file first.

Sheet header (fill in before the presentation): Date _____ · Case _____ · Format: Prepared / Boardroom / Traditional / Final · Prep time _____ · Judge _____ · Team _____

Scoresheet

#	Category	Weight	Official criterion — judges ask	Score (1–10)	Weighted
1	Implementation & Resources	×2.5	Is there a clear path to follow, with resources, time, and financial considerations?	____	____ /25
2	Analysis	×2.0	Is the assessment and recommendation substantiated by research, logic, and quantitative + qualitative analysis?	____	____ /20
3	Recommendation	×2.0	Is it effective, clear, comprehensive, and a strategic fit?	____	____ /20
4	Communicating Effectively	×1.0	Clear, professional, compelling presentation and a readable deck?	____	____ /10
5	Framing the Problem	×1.0	Are the issues wrapped into a clear, solvable summary (primary + secondary)?	____	____ /10
6	Impact	×1.0	Quantitative and qualitative benefit to the organization?	____	____ /10
7	Measurement, Risks & Mitigation	×1.0	Progress measurement and realistic risk mitigation?	____	____ /10
	Weighted total				**____ /105**

Behavioural anchors

1. Implementation & Resources (×2.5 — the single heaviest category)

- **3** — Implementation is one generic slide ("Phase 1/2/3") with no owners, no budget, no timeline; resources, time, and financial considerations are asserted, not shown.
- **7** — Credible phased roadmap with a timeline and cost estimates; resources named, but some figures are round guesses and the funding source or sequencing logic is thin.
- **10** — A clear path the client could start Monday: sequenced milestones with dates, named owners and headcount, an itemized budget reconciled with the case financials, funding source, and explicit time considerations.

2. Analysis (×2.0)

- **3** — Framework recital; case numbers restated rather than used; key claims unsupported by research or logic.
- **7** — Sound logic with relevant quantitative work (sizing, break-even) and qualitative insight; one or two assumptions unchecked or a data point ignored.
- **10** — Research, logic, and integrated quantitative + qualitative analysis all converge on the recommendation; assumptions stated and stress-tested; every claim traceable to case data or cited research.

3. Recommendation (×2.0)

- **3** — Vague or generic ("improve marketing"); does not follow from the analysis or fit this client's situation.
- **7** — Clear, actionable, and a plausible strategic fit; comprehensiveness or prioritisation slightly thin; alternatives dismissed too quickly.
- **10** — Effective, clear, and comprehensive; answers the client's actual question; strategic fit with mandate, constraints, and capabilities made explicit; alternatives weighed and rejected for stated reasons.

4. Communicating Effectively (×1.0)

- **3** — Reading from a cluttered, unreadable deck; uneven airtime; timing missed; Q&A rambles.
- **7** — Professional and clear; readable slides with action titles; confident answer-first Q&A; transitions or energy occasionally flat.
- **10** — A compelling story told to the judges, not the screen; clean, instantly readable deck; all four speakers strong; composed, precise Q&A; finishes on time.

5. Framing the Problem (×1.0)

- **3** — Problem restated verbatim from the case, or misidentified; no distinction between primary and secondary issues.
- **7** — Clear, solvable problem statement with the primary issue identified; secondary issues listed but loosely connected to the storyline.
- **10** — Sharp synthesis: primary and secondary issues wrapped into one clear, solvable summary that sets up the entire deck; scope and success criteria explicit.

6. Impact (×1.0)

- **3** — Benefits asserted ("this will increase revenue") with no numbers and no logic.
- **7** — Quantified upside with stated assumptions and named qualitative benefits; sizing partly rough or unconnected to the cost side.
- **10** — Credible quantified benefit (revenue, cost, or mission KPI) built from defensible assumptions, plus qualitative benefits tied to the organisation's goals — visibly worth the implementation cost.

7. Measurement, Risks & Mitigation (×1.0)

- **3** — No KPIs; risks absent or a token list without mitigations.
- **7** — Sensible KPIs and the top risks each paired with a mitigation; some generic; no targets, thresholds, or owners.
- **10** — Concrete KPIs with targets, review cadence, and owners; the material risks with realistic, specific mitigations and a trigger-based contingency where it matters.

Timing checklist per round (judge/coach runs the clock)

All formats: enforce prep exactly; phones/smartwatches surrendered before prep; one laptop per student; internet + GenAI allowed; **no coach contact after release**; deck collected at the fixed pickup time ("USB") — late arrival earns no extra prep or presentation time. Anonymity check: any mention of HSBI in front of a judge is flagged (real competition: **disqualification**).

Prepared case (25 % of score)

☐ Deck submitted before the deadline (.pptx by e-mail; late = bottom of the pool); no third-party slide template
☐ 25-min presentation: **yellow card at 5 min remaining, red at 1 min**

☐ 15-min Q&A: yellow at 5, red at 1
☐ Every member spoke

Boardroom case (30 %) — 4 h prep

☐ Deck + one-page black-and-white executive brief collected at pickup; brief handed to judges in advance; seated setup, keyboard/mouse ready
☐ **Protected 3 minutes:** uninterrupted, one summary slide only, appendices blocked; **red card at 1 min**
☐ **22-min discussion:** appendices accessible; yellow at 5, red at 1
☐ Every member spoke during the discussion (the 3-min pitch may be one voice)

Traditional case (45 %) — 3 h prep

☐ 20-min presentation: yellow at 5, red at 1
☐ 10-min Q&A: yellow at 5, red at 1
☐ Every member spoke

Final round

☐ **Deck frozen** — no changes after the finalist announcement; fresh judge panel; no advisor contact until after the presentation
☐ 20-min presentation + 15-min Q&A; yellow/red at 5/1 in both

Feedback template (complete within 15 minutes of the presentation)

- **Strength 1** (category): _____
- **Strength 2** (category): _____
- **Gap 1** (category + weight — prioritise the ×2.5/×2.0 categories): _____
- **Gap 2** (category + weight): _____
- **One drill** to close the biggest gap (name the source: `04-training/qa_drills.md`, `04-training/business_math_drills.md`, `04-training/presentation_and_storyline_guide.md`): _____
- **One improvement goal per person** (Finance / Innovation / CS / General Business) — transfer verbatim into `02-plan/simulation_log.md`: _____

Briefing an external judge

External judges are worth more than the coach at the same table: unfamiliar faces raise the pressure, and a practitioner's instinct for feasibility is exactly what the real panel brings. The calendar asks for external judges at **W17, W23–24, and both W25 rounds** — four occasions, which is the "at least 4 sessions" the preparation plan commits to — and **W19** is a graded simulation that deserves one if a judge is available. Recruit from HSBI faculty outside the team, alumni, or local practitioners — a consultant, a bank or brand manager, an NGO director.

The ask (e-mail or call, keep it this short). "Four Masters students are preparing for a graduate case competition in Canada in February. Would you judge one 3-hour case simulation — you arrive at *time*, watch a 20-minute presentation, ask 10 minutes of hard questions, score a one-page sheet we provide, and give 10 minutes of feedback? About 90 minutes in total, no preparation needed from you."

The 15-minute briefing before the round. Hand over this file and cover only these points:

1. **Your role.** Play the client's decision-maker, not a teacher. Be the person who would have to fund and own this recommendation.
2. **What is scored.** The seven categories on the sheet, in whole numbers 1–10, using the 3/7/10 anchors. **Implementation & Resources counts 2.5× — more than any other category.** If you remember one thing: ask who does what, by when, paid from where.
3. **How to question.** Practitioner questions, not academic ones: challenge the numbers and the feasibility. Interrupt if a claim has no evidence. Ask the same question twice if the first answer dodged it. Every team member should have to speak.
4. **The clock is hard.** Yellow card at 5 minutes remaining, red at 1. Do not extend it — the real competition does not.
5. **Feedback format.** Two strengths, two gaps, and — if you can — one thing you would drill. Blunt is a gift; these students would rather hear it in Bielefeld than in Winnipeg.
6. **What you do not need to know.** The case has a coach-only teaching note with a solution sketch; ask for it if you want it, but a fresh judge who has *not* read it often gives the more useful verdict.

Afterwards: the coach collects the sheets, transfers scores into `02-plan/simulation_log.md` within 24 h, and sends a thank-you. Ask each external judge whether they would return — a small standing panel that sees the team improve across autumn is worth a lot by January.